

“On Leaving | On Staying Behind”

MODULE OVERVIEW

Grade 12 ERWC with Integrated and Designated ELD

Module Type	Issue
Length of Instructional Time	2 weeks
Module Summary	The focus of this module is on negotiating different perspectives and meanings in a set of paired poems in preparation for writing creatively about immigrant experiences. The poems, “On Leaving On Staying Behind” (2014) by American Book Award-winner Diana Garcia, relate the experiences of a daughter and her mother as they contemplate the causes and possible effects of the daughter’s decision to leave her village and emigrate to a different country. The dialogic interaction between the poems and shifts in point of view make these literary texts rich candidates for rhetorical analysis, including discussion of ethos and context. The poems’ subject matter—the push factors and risks of emigration—also make them an excellent vehicle for introducing or reinforcing the concept of exigence: a critical need or problem that calls for a response. In addition to the poems, the module includes an interview with Garcia regarding the context and purpose of the poems, including Garcia’s source of inspiration.
Questions at Issue	• How are individuals impacted by the experience of emigration? • What does it mean to understand a text or perspective on its own terms? • What immigrant stories or perspectives are especially important to understand at this time?
Module Texts	Fletcher, Jennifer. “Interview with Diana Garcia.” 17 July 2017. ▪ This text is an interview with poet Diana Garcia about the inspiration for her work. Garcia, Diana. “On Leaving On Staying Behind.” <i>Prairie Schooner</i>, vol. 88, no. 4, 2014, pp. 11-13. ▪ These two poems deal with the conflicting feelings of emigrating, both the excitement and the worry. The module also includes an audio recording of these two poems.
Culminating Task	This module includes two major writing tasks: a brief, one-page literary analysis and a creative response to the issues and contexts Garcia addresses in her poems. The literary analysis will engage students in a close reading of the choices Garcia has made as a poet and the meanings she creates through those choices (i.e., themes). For the culminating writing task, students will choose one of three creative forms: a set of paired poems, a profile feature article, or a work of creative nonfiction (e.g., memoir or a reflective essay). The task thus affords students an opportunity to apply their understanding of literary craft, narrative strategies, and descriptive language to an original composition.

Rhetorical Concepts	• Perspective • Ethos • Context • Exigence
Objectives	Integrated ELD: • Describe how a poet's choices create meaning • Analyze the effects and functions of a poet's choices • Understand and respond to a critical need or issue addressed by a literary text • Make connections across texts and conversations • Use literary strategies to produce a creative work Designated ELD: • Understand the rhetorical effects of verbs and adjectives • Make strategic language choices
Potential Mini-Module Pairings	• Introducing Genre as Rhetoric • Introducing Kairos • Introducing Exigence • The Classical Pattern of Persuasion